Muscle Pairs · Pupil Resources

Learning goal: I can find a pair of arm muscles and show which muscle pulls to bend or make the arm straight.

Arrival Questions (In your book)

1. Which box shows the top muscle pulling?
2. Where do two bones meet and bend?
3. Can a bone move all by itself?
4. Can you ask an adult to help?

Starter Question

Why do we need two muscles at the elbow joint?

A. One muscle pulls the arm up, and the other pulls it back down.

B. One muscle pushes and one muscle sleeps.

C. Bones move without any muscles.

Method Strip

1. Put the Bend mat and Straight mat flat on your desk.
2. Rest one hand gently on your own upper arm and bend your elbow slowly. STOP AND CHECK.
3. Pick the card that shows the top muscle short and pulling.
4. Match the card for straightening the arm to the back muscle pulling.
5. Write or point to which muscle pulls and which

muscle rests.

Exit Ticket

Point to the muscle that pulls when your arm bends up: top or back?

What does the partner muscle do while one muscle pulls?

Why do muscles need to work in pairs at a joint?